DENNIS MWATHA MAINA

Software Developer | Full Stack

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Software Engineer with 2+ years of professional experience designing, building, testing, deploying, and maintaining modern web applications across the full software development lifecycle (SDLC). Skilled in TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Express.js, and PostgreSQL, with hands-on experience delivering responsive user interfaces, secure RESTful APIs, and role-based authentication systems. Experienced in database modeling with Prisma ORM, automated testing (Jest, Vitest, Playwright), and CI/CD pipelines using Docker and GitHub Actions. Analytical problem-solver committed to writing clean, maintainable, secure, and scalable software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML5, CSS3, Python
- **Frontend Development:** React.js, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, Responsive Web Design, Component-Based Architecture, State Management
- **Backend Development:** Node.js, Express.js, Next.js API Routes, Route Handlers, RESTful APIs, Middleware, Authentication, Authorization, JWT, Input Validation
- **Databases & ORMs:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Firebase, Prisma ORM, Relational Database Design, Database Migrations, CRUD Operations
- **Testing & Quality:** Jest, Vitest, Playwright, Unit Testing, Integration Testing, End-to-End Testing, ESLint, Prettier
- **DevOps & Cloud:** Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Vercel, Cloud Deployment, Environment Configuration
- **Tools & Architecture:** Git, GitHub, VS Code, Postman, Full-Stack Architecture, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Junior Full Stack Developer

Quest Designers | Nairobi, Kenya — *January 2024 – Present*

- Architect, develop, and maintain scalable full-stack web applications using TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Express.js, and PostgreSQL.
- Design relational database schemas and Prisma ORM data-access layers, and build secure RESTful APIs with OAuth/JWT authentication and role-based access control (RBAC).
- Build responsive, accessible UI component libraries with Next.js, Tailwind CSS, and modular component-based architecture.
- Containerize applications with Docker and configured GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines to run automated tests (Jest, Vitest, Playwright) and deploy to the cloud.

Freelance Software Developer

Independent | Remote / Kenya — *July 2024 – Present*

- I engineer custom, data-driven web applications for clients.
- Integrate third-party APIs, payment gateways, and external services with server-side validation and structured error handling.
- Manage the end-to-end SDLC for client projects, from requirements gathering through Git version control, deployment, and performance tuning.

Junior Software Developer (Intern)

Dewton Systems | Nairobi, Kenya — *August 2023 – November 2023*

- Developed responsive frontend views and integrated REST API endpoints using JavaScript, React, Node.js, and PostgreSQL.
- Executed database CRUD operations, optimized query performance, and supported senior engineers with full-stack debugging.
- Collaborated in an agile team through daily stand-ups, code reviews, and technical documentation.

SELECTED PROJECTS

ITSM Helpdesk — IT Service Management System

Tech Stack: *Next.js | TypeScript | PostgreSQL | Prisma ORM*

- Developed an ICT support platform for incident reporting, ticket management, and technical issue tracking.
- Implemented ticket prioritization, assignment workflows, status monitoring, and granular Role-Based Access Control (RBAC).

Task Board — Interactive Task Management Application
Tech Stack: *Next.js | React | TypeScript | PostgreSQL*

- Built a task management application supporting task creation, assignment, prioritization, and live progress tracking.
- Implemented Kanban-style workflow boards backed by persistent PostgreSQL data models.

BusinessFlow — SME Management Platform
Tech Stack: *React | Next.js | TypeScript | Node.js | PostgreSQL*

- Developed a scalable SaaS-style platform for managing customers, products, transactions, and core business data.
- Designed secure backend REST APIs and dashboard components that visualize transactional metrics.

Huduma360 — Digital Services Platform
Tech Stack: *Next.js | TypeScript | PostgreSQL | REST APIs*

- Developed a centralized platform for managing public and digital service requests and user profiles.
- Built secure REST API endpoints and responsive UI components for seamless user navigation.

AI-Powered Web Application
Tech Stack: *Next.js | TypeScript | React | PostgreSQL | External AI APIs*

- Integrated external AI APIs into a full-stack application using protected server-side API routes to safeguard credentials.
- Built authenticated user workflows with persistent PostgreSQL storage for AI feature requests.

EDUCATION

Diploma in Information Technology
Dedan Kimathi University of Technology | Nyeri, Kenya *2022 – 2023*
Relevant coursework: Database Programming, Software Engineering, Web Development, Systems Analysis, Computer Support

Self-Directed Software Engineering & Applied Technical Learning
Independent Study & Online Developer Training *2023 – Present*

- Advanced modern full-stack web development through self-directed study, open-source technical documentation, and hands-on project builds.
- Mastered core engineering skills in System Design & Architecture, TypeScript, Next.js App Router, PostgreSQL schema design, Prisma ORM, CI/CD pipelines, Docker containerization, and RESTful API architecture.

Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Nyeri High School | Nyeri, Kenya
Mean Grade: B- *2010 – 2013*

CERTIFICATIONS

Cloud

- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner — Amazon Web Services
- Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — Microsoft

Web Application Development

- Meta Front-End Developer Professional Certificate — Meta
- Meta Back-End Developer Professional Certificate — Meta
- FreeCodeCamp: Responsive Web Design, JavaScript, Relational Databases, Python, Backend Development & APIs, Full-Stack Developer Cerifications

DevOps

- Docker Foundations — Docker